

Contoso Retail — Customer Support Handbook (Demo)

Version 3.2 · Effective July 1, 2026 · Fictional company, for training only

1. Returns

- 1.1 Standard items may be returned within **30 days** of the purchase date.
- 1.2 A proof of purchase is required: an order ID, a receipt, or the card used for the purchase.
- 1.3 Items should be in original condition with tags attached where possible. Worn footwear is accepted only if the reason is a defect.
- 1.4 **Final-sale items** (marked "Final Sale" at checkout) cannot be returned unless they arrive damaged or defective.
- 1.5 **Opened electronics** may be returned within 30 days but are subject to a **15% restocking fee** unless the item is defective.
- 1.6 Online orders can be returned by mail (free prepaid label) or at any Contoso store. In-store returns are refunded immediately to the original payment method once approved.

2. Damaged or Defective Items

- 2.1 Items that arrive damaged must be reported within **7 days** of delivery.
- 2.2 The customer should provide at least one photo of the damage and the packaging.
- 2.3 Damaged-on-arrival items receive a free replacement or a full refund, including original shipping.
- 2.4 Defects found after 7 days fall under the product warranty (Section 5), not the damage policy.

3. Price Adjustments

- 3.1 If Contoso lowers the price of an item within **7 days** of purchase, the customer may request a one-time adjustment for the difference.
- 3.2 Price adjustments do not apply to competitor prices, clearance items, or flash sales shorter than 24 hours.
- 3.3 Adjustments are issued as a refund to the original payment method.

4. Exchanges

- 4.1 Size and color exchanges are free within 30 days and do not require the original item to be returned first; a hold is placed on the payment method instead.
- 4.2 Exchanges for a different product are processed as a return plus a new purchase.

5. Warranty

5.1 Electronics and small appliances carry a **1-year limited warranty** from the purchase date.

5.2 Warranty covers manufacturing defects. It does not cover accidental damage, water damage, or normal wear.

5.3 Warranty claims are handled by the Warranty Desk. Support agents open a claim and escalate; they do not approve claims.

6. Gift Returns

6.1 Gifts can be returned with a gift receipt within **45 days** of purchase.

6.2 Gift returns are refunded as Contoso store credit, never to the purchaser's payment method.

7. Contoso Rewards Members

7.1 Gold members receive an extended **60-day** return window on all non-final-sale items.

7.2 Rewards points earned on a returned item are deducted from the member's balance.

8. Escalation Rules

8.1 Escalate to a human agent when: the customer requests a refund above **\$200**, disputes a denied return, reports a safety issue, or mentions legal action.

8.2 Safety issues (overheating, burns, sharp edges, choking hazards) must be escalated immediately and logged as a product defect.

8.3 Support agents must never promise refund approval. They may confirm eligibility and explain next steps.